

SPORTSWEEK

Almonte Gazette columnist

Silver says

Charlie Kitts



Don't forget...the annual Big Brothers — Big Sisters fishing derby on Clayton Lake this Saturday...contact Rod Merrithew for details.

Happy New Year!...it never rains but it pours!...last week, in an attempt to wrap up an old year and get on with a new, the pen ran well...too well it seems...the good folks who have to make my column fit (always at the last minute) had to edit a few lines...the point of the column was that while it is great to set a little time aside to remember the past it is more exciting to contemplate the future...without getting too philosophical this would apply to all aspects of life...as we now look forward to a new year of unprecedented peace in the world's "trouble spots" and a growing appreciation for the environment and its future it is time to consider the professional sports world and the courses it could take in a never ending quest for the entertainment dollar.

The CFL...could become just that!...the Canadian Football League!...a CFL commissioner, like most professional league bosses, must do the bidding of the team owners...with the present move to ownership by the Gliedermans and McNalls and expansion into American cities we cannot expect the commissioner to stop the bleeding of Canadian content...we all know these types have a Paul Anka song as their theme (My Way)...so let's establish a Canadian football league...each team carries 35 players...a league-wide salary scale with a maximum of \$50,000 (they all have at least one other job)...another area of courses based on plus/minus, sacks, completions, etc...throw in a couple million for transportation and a million for coaching and administration...a \$5 million dollar...forget "personal services" and cap "scams" a la Louie!...no Americans need apply...to qualify you graduate from an accredited Canadian university, college, high school eliminate a lot of those who might try to beat the system!...play the games on our long wide fields...put Winnipeg back in the west where it belongs...eliminate domes, lawyers and agents...and bring back "fun" to the Canadian game...oh, by the way, 18 games with 15,000 seats at an average of \$20 each would cover all costs...television, concessions, merchandising and other sources would be pure profit (after taxes)...think about it!

The NFL...could be relegated to Saturday and Sunday mornings...there are fewer good hits in an endless game than there are in a "Roadrunner" cartoon...dads could share the couch with the younger set and a new type of "bonding" could occur...it will be difficult at first as the "younger set" will want to go back to the violence they have become used to in this time slot...the endless, inane statistical barrage that is an integral part of every game may even cause a "bring your calculator to the game" movement to emerge...it's a shame that the "Captain Kangaroo" of football announcers, John Madden, will be gone...I'm sure he will materialize at the more exciting moments of the game — the Budweiser commercials!...even that great south of the border tradition, the tailgate party, could continue, with some substitutions...this would also free up Sundays and Monday evenings for more animated programming...such as Mr. Rodgers or Jerry Lewis reruns!

The NHL...could stop their greedy expansion mania...let's face it, the time has come to start staffing many of the teams with a higher caliber of player...Junior B rejects demanding astronomical pay packages have changed the game for the worse...even the influx of talented European and East Bloc players is not enough...and the result in their homelands is something most international hockey fans have known for a long time...their talent pool is limited...siphon off a few "superstars," a la Yashin, and there is no great reservoir of skilled institutes...faced with the salary demands of the "nouveau riche" many franchises may now become itinerant, looking for greener pastures...here too, the elimination of agents, lawyers and prestige boxes would put both players and fans back in the rink for the "fun" of the game!

The NBA...could drop its annual pilgrimage for a "messiah" from the college ranks...under the leadership of Commissioner Stern the NBA has taken some giant steps back to credibility...limited expansion matched with a good supply of trained athletes keeps franchises strong...but, if faced with the "coming" of a superstar of the Shaquille O'Neal stripe, each year the pressure on salary caps will be unstoppable...the years that do not graduate a dominant individual will see mediocrity rewarded for the sake of maintaining a tradition.



A sprawling Kanata Hurricane goalie just manages to steer the puck aside as an Almonte-Pakenham forward tries to score from in close during last Wednesday's Atom B tournament in Carleton Place. The locals were all over Kanata at times, but lost a heartbreaking 4-3 decision in overtime. They were later topped 6-4 by Smiths Falls to drop out of the one-day event. Osgoode-Rideau won the tournament over the host Carleton Place B-1's, with Smiths Falls the consolation ('B' side) champions.

New curling draw starts this week at Pakenham club

The second draw started this week with all nights nearly filled. Friday night mixed has really become popular this year.

Congratulations to John Scott, Blake Wimpers, Brian Hudson and Brad Purdy who edged out the team of Peter Martin, Reg Davis, Claude Robillard, and Bruce Hill to be the winning men's team of the first draw. The team will be receiving the Allan Mann Insurance Trophy at the closing banquet.

The finals of the mixed in the first draw between Blake Wimpers' team and Dwayne Lowe's team had to be postponed due to conflicting times so this game will be played at a later date. The winning team will receive the Royal Bank trophy.

Dwayne and Jackie challenged the Arnprior Club to a friendly curling competition last Thursday night. The Arnprior Club won the challenge with a trophy being presented to that club's president Andy Stewart. Andy will definitely have this trophy on display.

This coming weekend is extremely busy for Pakenham curlers.

Pakenham will be hosting the fifth annual mixed cash 'spiel' this weekend. There will be 12 competitive mixed teams from throughout the valley doing battle for top money. This 'spiel' has become extremely successful with spectators being treated to some outstanding curling.

Pakenham will be sending a team to OCA Tankard playdowns hosted by the Arnprior and Renfrew curling clubs this weekend. Hopefully I will be able to report some wins for the Pakenham teams in next week's report.

Dwayne Lowe flooded the ice over the holiday and has the ice in outstanding shape. Pakenham can boast some of the best ice in the valley, thanks to Dwayne.

The monthly executive meeting will be next Wednesday, Jan. 10.

Good curling.

On the button

by Glenn Dean

CAPs Peewee 3 skate away with Richmond hockey tournament title with 6-1 final win

The CAPs (Carleton Place-Almonte-Pakenham) Peewee 3 team defeated West Carleton 6-1 in the final of a Richmond tournament Dec. 29.

It promised to be a tough game as West Carleton had beaten the locals decisively in the last two regular league encounters.

The CAPs' rivals jumped out to an early lead, scoring only three minutes into the game. But this was to be their only celebration of the afternoon.

Only a minute later Greg Scollan tied the game for the locals and with only 15 seconds left in the opening frame Nathan McGregor put the CAPs ahead for good.

Early in the second Joe Arbour converted a feed from McGregor to extend the lead to 3-1. The rout was on.

In the final stanza, the locals matched their output of the previous two periods, netting three more markers on the way to the final 6-1 score. Ryan McGregor, Nazaire Pelletier and Scollan were credited with the third period goals.

The championship game was

also marked by the outstanding defensive play of Brock Zeeman and several scintillating saves by Kyle Virgin.

On the day, the CAPs scored 21 goals, while allowing just four.

The CAPs opened the tournament with a 4-1 win over Gloucester. Goal scorers were Ryan McGregor, Scollan, Josh Morley and Shawn Hopewell.

The locals followed that up with a 10-0 whitewash over the host Richmond squad. Virgin picked up the shutout.

Hopewell, Morley and Arbour all scored a pair and singles went to Ryan McGregor, Jamie Lee, Matt Laforge and Pelletier.

Unfortunately due to illness and holidays, Brian Jones, Clint Butterworth and Patrick Robbs were unable to play.

Congratulations go to the coaching staff of Bruce Jardine, Mike Butterworth and Paul Virgin, as well as manager Rosemary Hopewell and all the players for an outstanding effort.

Biggest ever Easter Seal Snowarama kicks off

At least 60 community snowmobile clubs will be grooming their trails this winter as Ontario snowmobilers warm up for the biggest ever Easter Seal Snowarama.

Beginning in January, the Easter Seal Society and the Ontario Federation of Snowmobile Clubs (OFSC) are hosting snowmobile rides across Ontario to raise funds for children with physical disabilities.

Easter Seal Snowaramas provide Ontario children with physical disabilities with in-home nursing, accessible camping, financial assistance for equipment, parent support and research. The funds raised by service and snowmobile club volunteers help Easter Seal children in their own communities.

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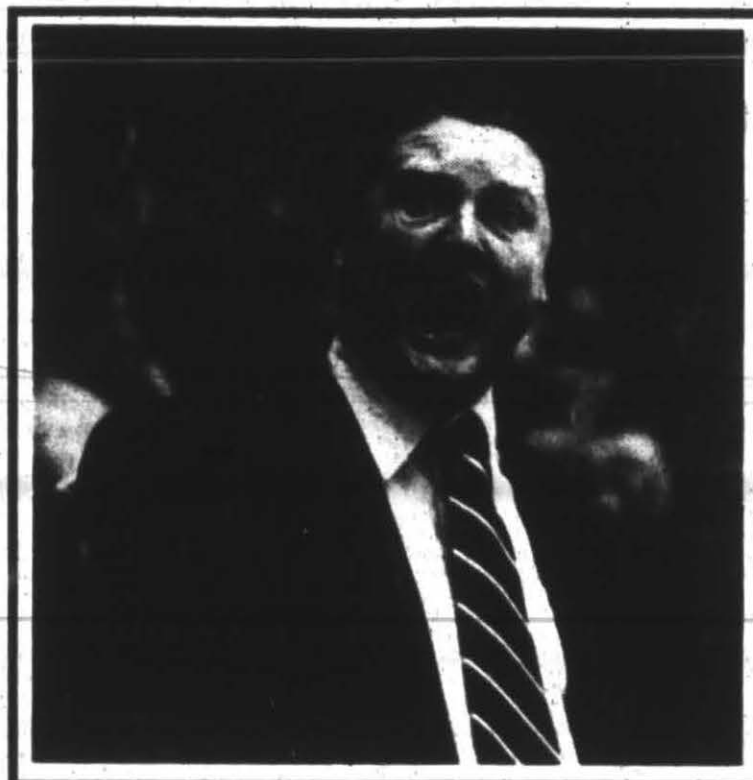
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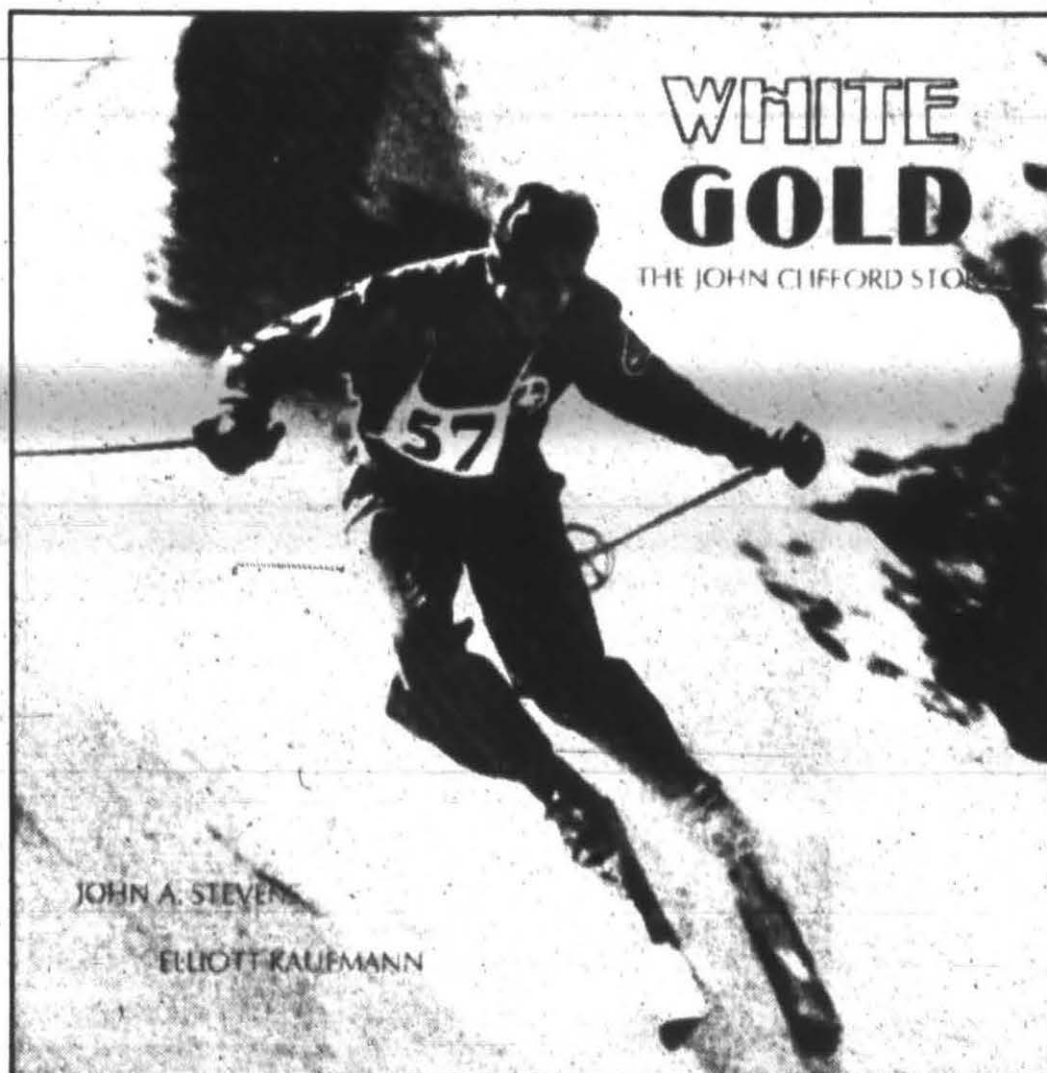
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